every other circumstance I have always been met with the unfailing kindness of strangers and India’s proverbial and fully deserved tradition of hospitality. That surely speaks volumes for the kind of nation that Gandhi, Nehru, Ambedkar and their colleagues built.

As a child of India, I take comfort in the knowledge that this motherland in which I dare to claim a stake has plenty of wise heads, first-rate historians and courageous journalists prepared to stand firm against the pick-and-choose anti-history-makers.[34] Long may such bastions of free speech be allowed to go about their business unconstrained.